

Living the Life of Christ

Introduction

Living the life of Christ is the process of dying to self so that the nature of Jesus can be expressed through daily actions. It is a fundamental shift in character, focus, and heart.

1. The Foundation of Love

At the core of Christ's life was sacrificial love (Agape). To live like Him means looking at people with compassion rather than judgment. It involves moving beyond liking people to actively seeking their highest good.

2. Radical Humility and Service

Jesus taught that the greatest among us is the one who serves. Living the life of Christ means looking for ways to support others without seeking recognition. It requires putting aside pride to perform acts of service for the community.

3. Submission to the Divine Will

Jesus consistently aligned His personal desires with God's purposes. This is achieved through prayer: maintaining constant communication with the Father, and obedience: choosing the path of integrity, even when it is difficult.

4. Forgiveness and Grace

A distinct marker of a Christ-like life is the ability to forgive. It means letting go of bitterness and the right to get even. Just as Christ offered forgiveness from the cross, we are called to extend mercy to others.

5. Integrity and Truth

Living like Jesus means your Yes is Yes and your No is No. It involves living with total transparency and honesty, whether people are watching or not.

6. Power through the Spirit

This life is not lived through human willpower alone. It is lived through the indwelling of the Holy Spirit, which produces the fruit of love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control.